EDUCATIONPLUS

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Look beyond rankings

Three questions student should ask before choosing a university

Geraint Rees

For generations, families choosing universities have relied on a familiar checklist: rankings, reputation and selectivity. The logic was straightforward: if an institution ranked higher, it was assumed to offer better preparation for the future. But the economy that today's students will navigate is different from the one their parents prepared for.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is transforming industries and reshaping the skills people will need. In this new landscape, the real question is no longer "Which university is the best?" but "Which university will prepare me for a future that's still taking shape?" When choosing institutions, rankings appear to offer clarity in a crowded world. But this can be misleading.

Rankings can capture useful information about research strength and reputation, but they don't tell you how students actually learn or how well they adapt once they leave. A university can score highly on both and still run lecture-heavy courses with little room for independent inquiry.

According to the World Economic Forum, nearly 44% of workers' core skills will change by 2027. AI can already analyse datasets in seconds, generate code, summarise documents and automate tasks that once required years of training. But what machines still struggle with are the human skills of curiosity, creativity and judgment; defining new problems, bridging disciplines and making decisions with incomplete information. These depend on how students are educated, not just what they are taught. When evaluating universities today, three questions can help:

First, what do graduates actually go on to do? A university's true value is shown not just in the job they land at 21, but in who they go on to become. Look beyond the university's own showcased alumni. Search LinkedIn for 10 recent graduates from the specific department or discipline you are considering, not the institution as a whole. Track where they are five years after graduation.

All this information is publicly available. Alumni networks, professional platforms such as LinkedIn and independent reports on graduate outcomes often reveal more about a university's influence than any marketing brochure. A pattern of adaptive, initiative-driven careers is a stronger signal than a list of famous names from decades past.

Second, what does the institution believe education is for? Some universities still treat education as a one-way transfer of knowledge within neatly defined boundaries. Others view it as developing thinkers who can navigate ambiguity, cross-disciplinary borders, and connect ideas. In an AI-driven world, the second approach is far more valuable.

Therefore, consider if a university rewards questioning or mastery of received wisdom. To assess this, read actual course syllabuses from the department you wish to join. Does the programme require a research project, ideally with an external partner or real-world brief? Are students encouraged to collaborate across fields, rather than remaining confined to a single subject?

Finally, what surrounds the university? Learning does not happen only inside lecture halls but also through engagement with industry, research organisations and communities. This too can be assessed before you apply. Look at whether the university has a technology transfer office with a documented track record of spin-out companies. Check whether faculty members appear on government advisory panels or in policy consultations. Consider the city or region: a university situated within an active technology or biomedical cluster will routinely connect students to live problems in ways that an isolated campus cannot, regardless of where both rank.

Universities that best prepare students for the future are embedded in vibrant innovation ecosystems: start-ups, research institutes, public agencies, creative industries. These partnerships give students the chance to work on real problems, not hypothetical ones, long before graduation. These experiences also cultivate an entrepreneurial spirit. Entrepreneurial spirit, in this sense, is not about business. It is an orientation: intellectual ownership rather than deference to authority, comfort with ambiguity rather than dependence on instruction, bias toward action rather than waiting for permission.

First filter

However, rankings are not worthless. They are a reasonable first filter and a way to identify institutions with research strength and global standing. But they should be the starting point, not the destination. Students who look at what graduates actually do, who read actual syllabi rather than summary descriptions, and who map the ecosystem around a university before accepting an offer are better placed before they even arrive.

The task is not to find the institution with the highest rank but to find the environment that will stretch students intellectually, expose them to diverse ways of thinking, and challenge them to engage with real-world issues. In the decades ahead, the universities that matter most will not simply be those with strong reputations but those that prepare students to not only navigate change but to drive it.

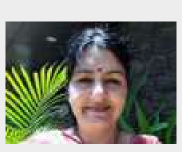
The writer is the Vice-Provost-Research, Innovation and Global Engagement, University College London, the U.K.

SCHOLARSHIPS

University of Surrey GREAT Scholarships India
Offered by the University of Surrey, the U.K., in partnership with the British Council under the GREAT Britain Campaign.
Eligibility: Indian citizens with a valid passport who have an unconditional offer to pursue a full-time postgraduate course from September. Applicants must engage in the U.K. higher education, attend networking events, and promote the value of U..K scholarships and maintain contact with the British Council to share their experiences with future candidates and scholars.
Rewards: £10,000.
Application: Online
Deadline: May 29
www.b4s.in/edge/USGS1

Newcastle University India Leadership and Innovation Scholarship
Offered by Newcastle University, the U.K.
Eligibility: Indian students with the equivalent of a first-class U.K. honours degree, hold an offer for an eligible full-time Master's or M.Res. course at the city centre campus from September and are classified as an international student for fee purposes.
Rewards: Full tuition fees.
Application: Online
Deadline: June 4
www.b4s.in/edge/NUII2

Courtesy: Buddy4study,com



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

Diversify your career path

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help

My daughter has done M.Sc. Environmental Science and is doing PG Diploma GIS. What are the job opportunities in India? What are her options for higher studies? Latha

Dear Latha,

M.Sc. Environmental Science provides understanding of pollution, ecology, and climate and the PG Diploma in GIS provides the 'technical tools' to map, analyse, and visualise that data. This profile is in high demand due to the government's focus on Smart Cities, Jal Jeevan Mission, and Climate Change Action Plans. She can work in organisations such as ISRO, NRSC, and IIRS; State Remote Sensing Centres and Pollution Control Boards (CPCB/SPCB), Forest Departments, and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).

In the private sector, consultancies like ERM, TERI, PwC, Esri India, and Here Technologies may have openings. Agri-tech start-ups and sustainability divisions of MNCs are another option.

For higher studies, she can consider a Ph.D. in Geomatics or Environmental Science. The CSIR-NET or UGC-NET will make her eligible for a Junior Research Fellowship (JRF) with a monthly stipend.

Countries such as Germany, Netherlands, Sweden value the GIS + Environment combination and often offer fully funded doctoral positions. Another choice is to learn Python for Geospatial Analysis or Google Earth Engine (GEE) through short-term certifications to become Geospatial Data Scientist.

I have done B.A. History and Tourism, and M.A. History. For two years, I have been preparing for the UPSC and UGC-NET but have not qualified. Should I do a B.Ed? I feel stuck. Keerthana

Dear Keerthana,

A B.Ed. will take two years but can offer a good job in government and private schools. But if you do not enjoy managing a classroom, you might find it draining despite the job security. Consider a shorter PG Diploma in Heritage Management or Archival Studies, which will open up options in the tourism/museum sector.

Other options you can consider are teaching in college but you will have to take the UGC-NET. You could also work in organisations like INTACH or the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) as a culture officer.

What about being a historical researcher or writer across travel blogs, production sets (for period dramas), and publishing houses?

You can also join a corporate or NGO in the Policy Research department. You can also teach at a coaching institute or an ed-tech platforms.

I have a Master's in Political Science. I don't want to study further. What are my options beyond UPSC or state PSC exams? Theresa

Dear Theresa,

Since you don't want to study further, look at public policy organisations such as NITI Aayog, Observer Research Foundation (ORF), Centre for Policy Research (CPR), and PRS Legislative Research for roles such as policy analyst, research associate or programme manager.

Large MNCs have departments that manage their relationship with the government and handle social responsibility. Firms like I-PAC or Matrize hire Political Science graduates to manage campaigns, analyse voter data, and craft political messaging. Look for roles such as programme associate, advocacy officer, communications officer.

Policy is now data-driven; knowing how to read a dataset makes you more employable. So think about courses in Data Analytics (Excel, Tableau, or basic Python). Level B1/B2 in a foreign language can land you jobs in embassies. Other options include content writing, PR and Corporate Communications.

I am a postgraduate in Library and Information Science. Are there any specific certifications required to work as a librarian abroad? Divya

Dear Divya,

Globally, your degree will be viewed as managing data, digital archives, and complex information systems. Depending on your interests, you can pivot into several specialised niches such as academic librarianship in the U.S., Canada, the U.K., and Australia, which involves working, in universities supporting research, managing digital repositories, and teaching Information Literacy. Large MNCs, law firms, and banks hire Information Officers to organise their internal data and proprietary research. Museums, art galleries and tech companies need experts to preserve digital assets for Digital Archiving & Curation. K-12 international schools (especially in West Asia) frequently recruit Indian postgraduates. With the rise of AI, Data Curators who can clean and categorise datasets for machine learning are becoming a new frontier for LIS graduates.

To work as a Librarian abroad, your Indian degree will have to be validated or supplemented by a local certification. In the U.S. and Canada, you need an American Library Association certification. Some states may have their own certifications for public libraries. In the U.K., the Chartered Institute of Library and Information Professionals (CILIP) offers Chartership, which is not mandatory but necessary for for senior roles. In Australia, you have to be a member of the Australian Library and Information Association (ALIA), and undergo an Overseas Qualification Assessment.

Consider certifications that will help your CV stand out globally. Digital Asset Management (DAM) on Coursera or LinkedIn Learning or Taxonomy and Metadata Standards will deepen your knowledge of Dublin Core, MODS, or RDA. Python or SQL for Data Management are becoming a requirement for Systems Librarians who manage library software. A Copyright and Intellectual Property course in international copyright law will be valuable for roles in research and publishing.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge


GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Doctors with depth

Why tomorrow's physicians need knowledge of more than just medicine

Dr. Rekha Arcot

The image of a doctor has traditionally been a professional grounded in anatomy, pharmacology, pathology, and clinical skill. For decades, this depth of knowledge has defined medical excellence. But healthcare in the 21st century is no longer a closed clinical ecosystem; it is shaped by artificial intelligence, digital health platforms, public policy, economics, and social inequalities.

One of the most urgent reasons for multidisciplinary learning is the widening technology gap in healthcare. AI is assisting in radiology reporting. Wearable devices are continuously tracking vital parameters. Electronic health records generate vast streams of data. Robotic systems are redefining surgery. Yet many medical graduates do not truly understand how they work. Interdisciplinary exposure to Engineering, Data Science, biomedical innovation, and health informatics allows physicians to evaluate digital tools critically rather than rely on them blindly.

Doctors do not need to become software developers, but they must understand algorithmic bias, data interpretation, cybersecurity risks and system limitations. When clinicians can collaborate meaningfully with engineers and technology developers, innovation becomes safer, more ethical and more patient-centric.

Human angle

At the same time, medicine cannot become purely technological. The Medical Humanities – Literature, Philosophy, Ethics, and reflective practice – ensure that clinical competence is balanced with human sensitivity. Literature sharpens narrative competence, enabling doctors to truly listen to patients' stories. Philosophy strengthens ethical reasoning, essential in end-of-life decisions, reproductive health dilemmas and emerging genetic technologies. Clinical ethics discussions build moral clarity in complex scenarios. In an age of machine-driven diagnostics, empathy becomes even more valuable. The humanities protect the soul of medicine.

Healthcare does not operate in isolation from economics or governance. Treatment decisions are influenced by insurance coverage, public health budgets, pricing regulations, and national health priorities. Understanding health policy and healthcare economics equips doctors to think beyond individual prescriptions. It enables them to ask: Is this intervention cost effective? How does policy influence patient access? How do reimbursement models shape clinical practice? Physicians who understand economics can contribute meaningfully to policy discussions, hospital administration, and systemic reforms. They become advocates not just for patients in clinics, but for communities within systems.

Health outcomes are profoundly shaped by non-medical determinants. Social Science offers insights into poverty, housing, sanitation, education and their impact on disease spread and recovery. A doctor treating tuberculosis must understand overcrowded living conditions. A physician managing diabetes must consider food accessibility and socio-economic constraints. Without awareness of these social realities, clinical advice risks becoming disconnected from lived experience.

Business and management education also play a growing role. Hospitals are complex organisations. Resource allocation, team leadership, conflict resolution, and quality improvement require managerial competence. Doctors often lead multidisciplinary teams; leadership without management training can limit impact. Interdisciplinary learning strengthens the physician's ability to function effectively within these broader systems.

'T'-shaped physician

The future doctor can be best described as a "T-shaped" professional. The vertical bar represents deep, specialised medical knowledge. This remains non-negotiable. Clinical expertise, diagnostic reasoning and procedural skill are the foundation of trust in medicine. The horizontal represents breadth; the ability to collaborate across disciplines, communicate with technologists, understand economists, engage with policymakers, and empathise with social realities.

This fosters enhanced problem-solving. Complex health challenges rarely have single-cause solutions. Antimicrobial resistance, lifestyle diseases, pandemics and mental health crises require integrated thinking. Interdisciplinary exposure also strengthens empathy and cultural competence. When doctors understand literature, sociology and philosophy, they develop a deeper appreciation for diversity, belief systems and patient narratives.

Finally comes adaptability. Medicine is evolving at unprecedented speed. Treatments change. Technologies disrupt. Policies shift. Doctors who are trained within rigid disciplinary boundaries may struggle to adjust. Those exposed to multiple perspectives develop intellectual flexibility and resilience.

Interdisciplinary learning does not mean diluting medical rigour. It means enriching it. Medical curricula must integrate collaborative projects with engineering departments, ethics seminars, policy discussions, community immersion programmes, and leadership training.

The goal is not to produce generalists without depth, but specialists with perspective. Tomorrow's doctors will practise in a world of genomic medicine, digital platforms, global migration, climate-related health crises, and economic uncertainty. To serve patients effectively, they must understand not only disease, but systems, technology, society and humanity. Medicine remains the core. But medicine alone is no longer enough.

The writer is Dean, Dr. D.Y. Patil Medical College, Hospital and Research Centre, Pune.

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Pankaj Muthe

Gain the edge

Why the industry will value data-ready graduates more than AI-ready graduates in the future

By the end of 2026, familiarity with AI tools will no longer differentiate graduates; it will simply be expected. Modern AI systems are advancing rapidly and can assist with anomaly detection, pattern recognition, and aspects of data quality assessment. These expand what AI-ready graduates can accomplish. At the same time, organisations are discovering that AI effectiveness still depends heavily on human judgment about whether the underlying data is reliable, complete, and appropriate for the decision at hand.

Workforce trends already reflect this shift. According to the India Skills Report 2026, more than 40% of India's IT and gig workforce uses AI tools for automation, analytics, or creative tasks, and overall employability has risen to nearly 56% from 54% last year. This signals growing digital readiness across sectors. It also highlights why employers increasingly value graduates who can pair tool fluency with strong data judgment, questioning assumptions and validating outputs before decisions are made.

At the foundation

As enterprises scale AI, hiring priorities are evolving. Gartner forecasts that, through 2026, organisations will abandon a significant share of AI initiatives due to poor data readiness. Industry experience consistently shows that many AI projects struggle not because algorithms are weak but because data is incomplete, inconsistent, or lacks context. For students, this is a critical lesson. Understanding data integration, quality, lineage, and bias is as important as learning how to use AI models. Education must move beyond the excitement around large language models to build deeper capabilities in evaluating whether AI outputs can be trusted.

Higher education is beginning to recognise that data maturity is as important as technical proficiency. Workplaces increasingly require professionals who can evaluate whether analysis is appropriate in the first place, not just how to execute it. Graduates who understand how data is collected, processed, and governed are better prepared to interpret results and communicate insights responsibly.

Academic environments often rely on clean datasets designed for instruction, while real-world data is messy and fragmented. Exposure to imperfect data during education helps develop critical reasoning. Students who work with conflicting records, missing values, and unclear provenance learn to make defensible decisions under uncertainty and understand how small data issues can escalate when AI systems operate at scale.

Hands-on learning

Across India, universities are expanding practical learning through Centres of Excellence, datathons, and industry collaborations that give students experience with real datasets and applied problem solving. These initiatives complement academic curricula by creating environments where students learn not only how to use tools but how to interpret data in real business contexts.

Moving beyond tool-based instruction requires a shift in pedagogy. Case-based learning and projects built around imperfect datasets teach students to evaluate assumptions, communicate uncertainty, and justify conclusions. These experiences mirror professional workflows, where assessing data fitness is a prerequisite to analysis.

Graduates entering the workforce will benefit most from developing complementary strengths in both AI fluency and data judgment. Mastery of tools enables speed and efficiency, while data readiness provides the context needed to use those tools responsibly. As AI automates routine tasks, the differentiator becomes the ability to interpret results, understand context, and ensure decisions are grounded in reliable information.

In an AI-saturated world, advantage will not come from access to tools, but from the ability to question, interpret, and apply them responsibly. Graduates who combine these capabilities will not just participate in an increasingly data-driven economy, they will help shape it.

The writer is Senior Academic Programme Manager, APAC, Qlik.

AI for all

Hrishikesh Dewan, co-founder and CEO of Ziroh Labs, on his domain

FUTURE PERFECT
Ananya Ganapathy

The next in the series featuring conversations with entrepreneurs, technologists and researchers about emerging technologies and what students need to know about these fields.

What do you do?

I am the co-founder and CEO of Ziroh Labs. We work at the convergence of advanced mathematical concepts and sophisticated distributed-system algorithms to efficiently execute open-source foundational models on Central Processing Units (CPUs). Through research and development, we hope to bring down the barrier of access to AI technology and make it available to a broader range of individuals, businesses, and organisations.

Why is your work important globally?

Today, access to AI infrastructure is skewed. Most advanced AI systems rely on Graphics Processing Units (GPUs), which are expensive and not readily accessible. This creates a divide that only well-funded organisations can fully overcome. Our product, Kompact AI, enables AI to run on CPUs that are already widely available and cost-effective. If AI is to be truly democratised, it must run on infrastructure that is accessible across geographies. By reducing cost barriers and enabling scalable deployment, we aim to make AI more inclusive and globally available.

What is exciting about your work?

The problems we are solving are deeply scientific and require both fundamental research and precise engineering. The journey involves constant experimentation, failure, and iteration. I also see technology as a form of art. A well-engineered solution, in many ways, is no different from a good poem or a good play. The combination of discovery, creativity, and real-world impact makes this work deeply engaging.

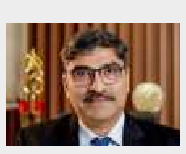
Any experiences in college that led you to become an entrepreneur?

Cotton College in Guwahati and later IISc-Bengaluru played an important role in shaping my thinking. Cotton College exposed me to a culture of ideas and intellectual responsibility, while IISc taught me to approach problems scientifically and accept failure as part of the process.

What should students specifically know about your field?

Solving meaningful and crucial problems demands deep scientific inquiry and comes with setbacks and a few hard-earned wins. Failure is acceptable and learning to wait is essential. Technology transcends geographies and cannot be confined to a single region. Students should think globally while remaining grounded in strong fundamentals, honesty, and sincere work. In the context of AI and computing, this means building a strong foundation in algorithms, data structures, and system design, while understanding how models learn from data. Equally important is developing the ability to critically evaluate outputs, ensuring reliability, efficiency, and responsible use of AI systems.

The writer is an avid follower of emerging technologies and their applications.



THE KNOWLEDGE GAP
Ram Kumar Kakani

Every choice matters

How a 1970s developmental theory can help reshape the way institutions think about students, development and reform

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

There is a Jataka tale about a rich merchant who owns a parrot gifted in philosophy. The bird can recite virtues immaculately but cannot practise them because no one in the house models them. The merchant has provided everything except the one thing that matters: an ecosystem.

Urie Bronfenbrenner, the developmental psychologist whose Ecological Systems Theory reshaped global thinking on childhood education and learning, would have recognised the problem. His central insight was simple: you cannot understand a student (fish) by studying the student (fish) alone. You must study the water they swim in.

Changing scene

Indian education is changing and, for once, not cosmetically. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020's target of 50% Gross Enrolment Ratio by 2035, the promised autonomy under the proposed Higher Education Commission of India, the push for multidisciplinary learning, and global linkages signal a system finally willing to ask harder questions about itself.

The next frontier is implementation that goes all the way down from policy corridors to classroom culture. As ecologists know, a forest does not transform because one corner gets new weather. But when the whole ecosystem shifts, even old roots find new growth. Bronfenbrenner's framework helps explain why.

Think of it as five rings around each student. The first is the Microsystem or the immediate world. The classroom, the hostels, the teacher who stays back after class, and the ensuing daily interactions shape learning more than any policy. The teacher-student relationship remains the strongest developmental lever.

Second comes the Mesosystem. This involves the connections between worlds. Do counsellors know what happens in the classrooms? Do course coordinators talk to placement cells? Do faculty senates understand first-year fears? In many institutions, the silos are structural, not personal.

Third is the Exosystem, comprising decisions students never see such as timetables, teachers' workload, library hours, scholarship disbursement, infrastructure budgets. But they feel the consequences every day.

Fourth is the Macrosystem. The culture and norms surrounding us. India's exam-centric definition of merit, the tension of English-medium instruction vs mother-tongue aspirations, gender norms on campus, and the vast variation in institutional quality form the cultural air students breathe.

Finally, the Chronosystem or the time factor. A student who started college during the pandemic will carry a different developmental history from one starting in the age of generative AI and geopolitical uncertainty.

In the Mahabharata, Ekalavya's Microsystem was a self-built clay statue and a forest. His Macrosystem was a caste-inflected idea of who deserves a *gurukul*. Bronfenbrenner helps us see Eklavya's thumb not as tragedy but as structure: talent in a hostile ecosystem pays a hidden tax.

Bronfenbrenner emphasises bi-directionality: students are not passive recipients. A student who asks difficult questions changes what gets taught. A student body that demands amicable timetables reshapes the Exosystem. Similarly, a generation choosing climate policy or indigenous knowledge systems reshapes the Macrosystem. The framework is a map of the space students already inhabit.

Systems thinking

Bronfenbrenner asks leaders to stop thinking in departments and start thinking in systems. A principal or director who redesigns curriculum but ignores faculty well-being has improved the Microsystem but left the Exosystem untouched. A registrar digitising admission but neglecting the quality of mentoring has fixed the plumbing but not the water. Accreditations measure research output but miss whether a first-generation learner feels that they belong. That belonging predicts dropout rates more accurately than any rank.

Institutions that get this right invest in faculty development, design training orientations that attend to emotional transition, and build feedback loops that operate in weeks and not semesters get it right. A dean's tone, campus design, and how complaints are handled teach as powerfully as any syllabus. Every institution teaches both what it intends and what it enacts. The gap between the two is where development happens.

Draw five circles. Place yourself (fish) at the centre. Populate each ring honestly. The merchant in the Jataka tale assumed proximity to virtue was the same as an ecology of virtue. Perhaps, the Indian education has often made the same mistake. But ecosystems are buildable. In a country of over 14 lakh schools and 43,000 colleges, every design choice matters.

The writer is the Vice-Chancellor of RV University, Karnataka

POSTCARD FROM --- SHEFFIELD

Engineering a future with AI

A student talks about her journey from Pune's academic culture to Sheffield's global classrooms

- Name: Harshada Vaidya
- Course: M.Sc. AI for Engineering
- University: University of Sheffield, the U.K.

I grew up in Pune and, being around engineers, innovators, and academics from a young age encouraged me to aim higher. I wanted to see the world, learn about new technology, and build a career that matters. This led me to the University of Sheffield. While doing postgraduate research in India, I saw how AI and automation were changing engineering by improving systems, predicting failures, and creating efficiencies that older methods could not. So I opted for the M.Sc. AI for Engineering at Sheffield as a bridge between my engineering background and the advanced AI applications shaping industries worldwide.

The university's reputation as part of the Russell Group made it an easy choice. But what stood out for me was the sense of history on campus. As you walk through the university, you realise that many mathematicians, scientists, business leaders, and even Nobel Prize winners once walked these same halls.

Global exposure

My course curriculum brings AI and engineering together in a meaningful way and classmates from all over the world share different viewpoints in every discussion. Outside of class, the department has strong industry links through guest lectures, workshops, career fairs, and networking events. The Career Mentoring Scheme matches students with alumni working in industry, giving us guidance from someone who has also taken a similar path.

The individual project was the most challenging and rewarding part of my studies. My project is about modelling the twin screw granulation process with MATLAB, a continuous manufacturing method used in the pharmaceutical and chemical industries. Creating these computational models not only helped highlight my skills but also showed me, more than any lecture could, what it really means to use AI to solve real engineering problems, working through complex issues, dealing with uncertainty, and finding solutions that stand up to careful review.

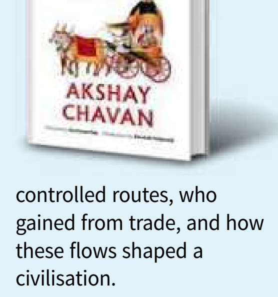
Apart from academics, as an International Student Ambassador, I help future students learn what studying in the U.K. is like. I stood for the post of International Student Representative and finished as the runner-up, which encouraged me to connect with the wider community. Being part of the Indian and Postgraduate Societies has helped me stay close to my roots while making friends from different cultures. Receiving the International Postgraduate Taught Scholarship 2025 was not just a recognition of my academic performance and leadership potential but also a reminder to me that hard work is noticed.

Beyond the degree

Sheffield is often called England's greenest city and has a friendly and welcoming atmosphere with a sense of community. That sense of belonging, both inside and outside the classroom, ties everything together and has made this journey more than just a degree. This programme has not only helped me understand AI better but also changed how I see the world. I have gained confidence from working in an international setting and built a network across countries.

ON THE SHELF

The Wealth Networks



A striking reinterpretation of Indian history through the routes that carried money, goods, people and ideas, the book tracks the networks beneath them: the strategic corridors that determined which cities rose, which kingdoms fought, and where wealth accumulated. The narrative connects geography, commerce, and society into a history of India that is more about who controlled routes, who gained from trade, and how these flows shaped a civilisation.

Author: Akshay Chavan
Publisher: Penguin
Price: ₹999

Immune to Age

Long misunderstood as merely the body's first line of defence against disease, we are only now beginning to understand the crucial role that the immune system plays in how we age. This mind-bogglingly complex network drives everything from metabolic function to brain health, and it is the single greatest arbiter of our lifespan and our healthspan.
This book explores the importance of good immune health at every stage of life, from conception to our wintering years.

Author: Dr. Jenna Macciochi
Publisher: Hachette
Price: ₹799